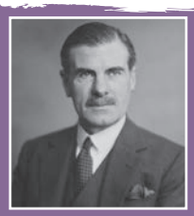
The city of Madras now known as Chennai was the capital of the Presidency. In 1862, the province was divided into 22 districts. Then it was divided into 24 districts. Later in 1911, the province was further divided into 26 districts including North Arcot, South Arcot, Chingleput, Madras, Salem, Coimbatore, Trichinopoly, Tanjore, Madura, Ramnad, Tinnevelly and Nilgiris in Tamil Nadu. It was under British rule until 1947.



The first British Governor of Madras Presidency was Edward Clive and the last Governor was Archibald Edward Nye.


Archibald Edward Nye

After Independence

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After 147 years of its formation, the Madras Presidency was renamed as Madras State in 1947 as India gained independence.

In 1956, the Madras State consisted of (four regions comprising of) 13 districts namely Madras, Chengalpattu, North Arcot, South Arcot, Salem, Tiruchirapalli, Thanjavur, Coimbatore, The Nilgiris, Madurai, Tirunelveli, Ramanathapuram and Kanniyakumari. It was officially renamed as Tamil Nadu in 1967. Let us learn more about the four regions of Tamil Nadu.

REGION I

Madras

The modern districts of Chennai, Tiruvallur and Kancheepuram constituted the Madras district. British bought a part of the land from the Nayak rulers in 1639. They built Fort St. George and named the area Madrasapattinam.


Fort St. George

Gudiyam Caves are rock shelters in South India and are known for their prehistoric stone tools and evidence of humans living there near by two lakh years ago.

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